I AM CHAD

FITNESS RPG | GAME DESIGN DOCUMENT

Every hero starts somewhere.

Version 0.1 • Concept / pre-production • 22 October 2026

Working title; trademark clearance pending.

1. Executive overview

I Am Chad: Fitness RPG is an offline-first, cross-platform mobile experience that makes sustainable exercise feel like a fantasy adventure. Players log real workouts, develop a customizable adventurer, complete approachable quests, and progress through replayable turn-based encounters. Chad, an exuberant but supportive guildmaster, teaches the basics and celebrates effort without shaming beginners.

Attribute	Decision
Genre	Fitness tracker + light fantasy RPG
Audience	Fitness beginners, returning exercisers, and casual RPG fans
Platforms	Android and iOS
Technology direction	Flutter (application/UI) + Flame (2D game scenes), Dart
Business model	Free essential fitness and gameplay; optional non-exploitative support
Core promise	Exercise at your own level; enjoy meaningful progress without pressure

2. Vision and design pillars

- Fitness first: useful exercise logging, clear history, and achievable personal goals even when RPG features are ignored.
- Beginner-friendly: gentle onboarding, accessible exercise substitutions, understandable instructions, and no fitness gatekeeping.
- Progress without punishment: rest days count as responsible training; missed days never erase progress.
- Adventure with agency: players create their hero; Chad mentors rather than replacing the protagonist.
- Endless but bounded: new encounters and quests can continue indefinitely without requiring ever-increasing physical workloads.
- Trustworthy design: transparent rewards, privacy-conscious tracking, and no pay-to-win mechanics.

3. Target player experience

A new player chooses a comfortable starting level, meets Chad, creates an adventurer, and completes a brief optional introductory activity. Their exercise is recorded in a real fitness log, then translated into in-game rewards. A short quest or battle offers immediate payoff. On later visits, players can choose a suggested session, log their own workout, explore the guild, or play a recovery-friendly activity.

4. Core gameplay loop

Stage	Player action	System outcome
Prepare	Choose a suggested quest or free-form workout	Displays goal, options, modifications, and safety guidance
Move	Perform activity in real life; manually log or import supported data	Creates an editable workout record
Validate	Review reps, sets, duration, distance, or load	Awards bounded activity XP / adventure energy

Adventure	Spend earned energy on a short encounter or expedition	Turn-based battle, loot, narrative event
Progress	Upgrade hero, collect equipment, inspect fitness history	Long-term RPG progression and real-world insight
Recover	Rest, stretch, or play low-intensity guild content	No streak loss or penalty

5. Fitness systems

5.1 Activity catalog

Category	Initial examples	Recorded fields
Bodyweight	Push-ups, squats, sit-ups, planks	Sets, reps, duration, variant
Cardio	Walking, running	Duration, distance, optional perceived effort
Resistance	Dumbbell/barbell exercises	Exercise, sets, reps, load
Mobility / recovery	Stretching, light mobility	Duration and optional notes

The MVP uses manual entry; sensor-based rep detection and location tracking are not required. Workouts can be edited or deleted. Exercise demonstrations should use licensed/original material, simple form cues, and easier alternatives. The app must not claim medical authority.

5.2 Personalization and safety

- Onboarding asks experience level, preferred activities, available equipment, goals, and accessibility preferences; avoid collecting unnecessary sensitive information.
- Recommendations begin conservatively and can be skipped or adjusted at any time.
- Rewards recognize consistency relative to personal baseline, not absolute strength or body size.
- Display rest guidance, a stop-if-pain warning, and clear distinction between game feedback and professional health advice.
- Do not infer exercise quality from manual entries or advertise automated verification when none exists.

5.3 Example workout and rewards

Example: a player logs two comfortable sets of wall push-ups and a ten-minute walk. Both are saved as fitness records. The game grants a modest, capped amount of adventure energy and XP according to transparent activity rules. A player doing a smaller or modified workout should still receive meaningful progress.

6. RPG systems

6.1 Player character and hub

The player creates a customizable adventurer (appearance, name, cosmetic equipment). The Adventurer's Guild is the hub for Chad, workout quests, expedition selection, inventory, progression, and activity history. Chad offers humorous dialogue and optional coaching, with reduced interruptions for experienced users.

6.2 Combat and expeditions

Combat is short, turn-based, and readable on a phone. Players choose basic actions such as Attack, Guard, Skill, and Item. Expedition runs are seeded sequences of battles, rewards, and events. The MVP contains a small handcrafted encounter pool with randomized ordering; complex procedural maps are post-MVP.

6.3 Progression and economy

- Character XP unlocks options and modest stat gains; combat scaling uses soft caps to prevent runaway power.
- Activity-derived adventure energy controls how many reward-bearing encounters can be initiated, but players retain meaningful non-exercise activities.
- Equipment rewards are earned through play; avoid gambling-like loot boxes and paid power.
- Quests include optional daily suggestions, flexible weekly goals, and self-directed adventures; no compulsory streaks.
- Difficulty scales mainly through tactics, enemy variety, and player choice—not escalating exercise demands.

7. Chad: mentor and tone

Chad is a self-proclaimed legendary guildmaster: confident, theatrical, warm, and occasionally unreliable about his own exploits. He teaches exercise fundamentals without humiliating beginners. He is not the playable protagonist. Dialogue is contextual, skippable, and written to avoid guilt or body-shaming.

Sample line: “Every legend started at Level 1. Except me. I started at Level 2. Long story.”

8. Main screens and navigation

Screen	Primary purpose
Home / Guild	Next recommended action, Chad dialogue, hero status
Workout	Choose activity, start timer, enter sets/reps/load
History	Calendar/list of sessions and personal trends
Quests	Optional personal goals and earned rewards
Adventure	Turn-based encounters and expedition progress
Character	Customization, equipment, skills, progression
Settings	Units, accessibility, notifications, privacy, data export

9. Accessibility and responsible design

- Readable typography, contrast, screen-reader labels, scalable text, reduced motion, and non-color-only feedback.
- One-handed-friendly navigation and short session lengths.
- No public body measurements, compulsory social comparison, or shame-based reminders.
- Recovery days and accessibility modifications must remain valid participation.
- Any future health integrations require explicit permissions and clear data-use explanations.

10. Technical architecture

Layer	Planned approach
UI and navigation	Flutter widgets; responsive layouts for Android/iOS
Game scenes	Flame for lightweight 2D combat, animations, effects
App state	Riverpod or equivalent testable state management

Local persistence	SQLite via Drift; offline-first workout and save data
Domain logic	Pure Dart modules for reward rules, quest generation, combat
Cloud (later)	Optional account/sync backend, e.g. FastAPI + PostgreSQL
Health integrations (later)	Apple HealthKit / Android Health Connect, permission-based

Treat workout data as the source of truth. The RPG consumes derived, versioned rewards; changing game balance must not alter historical exercise records. Use deterministic seeds for encounters and tests. Design sync conflict resolution before enabling multi-device accounts.

11. Content and art direction

Visuals: welcoming, slightly comedic fantasy with clean silhouettes, warm guild interiors, readable battle effects, and accessible UI. Prefer original assets or assets with documented commercial licenses. Audio should reward effort without overwhelming the workout experience. Chad's design should be original and not reproduce recognizable meme photography or third-party characters.

12. Monetization and privacy

Essential tracking, beginner instruction, and core RPG progression remain free. Potential future revenue: optional donations, cosmetic supporter packs, or permanent narrative expansions. No gacha, paid XP, energy purchases, manipulative streaks, or resale of sensitive fitness information. Provide local export and deletion tools. Prepare platform-specific privacy disclosures before release.

13. MVP scope and exclusions

Must ship in first playable version	Defer until later
Basic onboarding and character creation	Multiplayer / guild social features
Manual logging for bodyweight and cardio	Camera-based rep recognition
Local history and simple goals	GPS route tracking and wearables
Chad tutorial and contextual dialogue	Large voiced narrative campaign
One short turn-based combat mode	Full procedural dungeon maps
Seeded encounter variations and rewards	Cloud accounts and cross-device sync
Accessible settings and offline saves	Extensive equipment / crafting systems

14. Production milestones (illustrative, part-time solo)

Weeks	Deliverable	Exit criterion
1–2	Project skeleton, data models, wireframes	Launches on emulator; records persist locally
3–5	Workout catalog and logging	Can log, edit, delete, and review workouts
6–7	Onboarding, quests, rewards	Personalized beginner goals and bounded XP work

8–10	Character, guild, Chad dialogue	Core screens connected with placeholder art
11–13	Combat and expeditions	One complete repeatable adventure loop
14–16	Polish, accessibility, testing	Stable playable prototype on Android/iOS test devices

15. Validation and success criteria

- New users can log a first workout without needing to understand RPG systems.
- Players understand why a workout earned its rewards and can correct mistakes.
- The game remains fun and respectful during a rest week.
- Core data works offline and survives restart.
- A short expedition can be completed in a few minutes.
- Usability testing with fitness beginners identifies confusing terminology or discouraging messages.

16. Risks and mitigations

Risk	Mitigation
Users overexercise for rewards	Reward caps, diminishing returns, rest-friendly play, no punishment
Manual workout entries can be exaggerated	Design for personal honesty, not competitive verification
Scope creep	Protect MVP boundaries and postpone integrations
Fitness guidance causes confusion	Use conservative cues, clear disclaimers, qualified review where possible
Game title/branding conflicts	Treat “I Am Chad” as provisional pending trademark clearance
Sensitive data exposure	Offline-first storage, minimal collection, explicit permissions

17. Open design decisions

- Exact reward formula and daily caps; test for fairness across abilities.
- Combat class/skill design and whether workouts influence specific stats.
- Age rating and whether minors are supported.
- Whether early release includes weightlifting or adds it immediately after MVP.
- Original art pipeline and asset licensing budget.
- Final title and trademark clearance for intended markets.

Document status: concept-level GDD. Numbers, mechanics, schedules, and platform integration choices are proposals to validate in prototyping—not final implementation requirements.